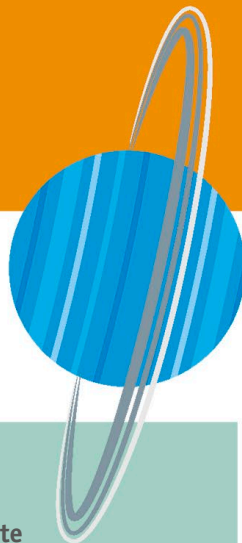


March

13



Uranus discovered 1781

British astronomer William Herschel discovered the planet Uranus while studying the stars. Although others had spotted light from the remote world before, Herschel recognized it as a new planet – the first to be found since ancient times.

Also on this day

1925 This date was chosen to celebrate **600 years** since the city of Tenochtitlán was established on Lake Texcoco as the capital of the Aztec Empire.

1954 The **KGB was founded** as the security agency for the Soviet Union. It soon became one of the world's most effective organizations for gathering secret information.

1988 The **Seikan Tunnel opened** to connect the Japanese islands of Honshu and Hokkaido. The undersea section of the 54 km (34 mile) railway tunnel is buried 100 m (328 ft) below the seabed.

Born this day

1733 Joseph Priestley, British chemist. Through his scientific experiments, he discovered many gases, including oxygen. He also invented carbonated (sparkling) water.

1848

March revolution

As revolution spread across Europe, protesters demanding political change rioted in the Austrian city of Vienna. Hoping to calm the people and restore peace, the government forced the unpopular Prince Metternich, chancellor of Austria, to resign.



1997 Phoenix Lights

Sightings of unidentified flying objects (UFOs) in a V-shape formation were reported by many people observing the evening skies over Arizona and Nevada in the USA. The puzzling lights caused much debate, but the mystery was never solved.

